

period saw the 30-share barometer gaining nearly 15 per cent or around 8,400 points. Further, the subdued rise happened even as more than 300 companies registered a rise in their respective market capitalisations in this year's BT500 list and over 50 firms saw their profits more than double in FY23, when compared to the previous fiscal.

Another interesting trend witnessed this year was around the new entrants as a majority of the debutants were comparatively much smaller in size when compared to their counterparts in the previous year's study. But first let's have a look at the toppers that include the Street favourites—that have remained favourites consistently over the years—even as some of the

biggies saw their valuations dip and were overtaken by entities that were much smaller earlier.

TOP OF THE CHARTS

There has been no change in the Top 3 occupants on the BT500 list with Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL) topping it, followed by Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) and HDFC Bank. The private sector lender registered a 19.4 per cent rise in its average market capitalisation during the period under review, while the other two saw their valuations dip.

Meanwhile, ICICI Bank has broken into the Top 5 this year by jumping two positions to No. 4, while FMCG major Hindustan Unilever (HUL) occupies the No. 5 spot. It is followed by Infosys and State Bank

of India (SBI)—in that order—while ITC breaks into the Top 10 at No. 8; the FMCG major was at No. 13 in 2022 and has seen a 54.3 per cent rise in its valuation. Bharti Airtel and Bajaj Finance at No. 9 and No. 10, respectively, round up the Top 10.

In terms of valuation, four of the Top 10 firms—RIL, TCS, Infosys and Bajaj Finance—have seen their respective market capitalisations dip even as the aggregate valuation of the 10 companies has risen a little over 6 per cent. Insurance behemoth Life Insurance Corporation (LIC), which made a high-profile debut at No. 9 on the list in 2022, follows the Top 10 this year at No. 11, with a 10.8 per cent fall in its valuation.

Another interesting trend has been the performance of Adani Group firms. In contrast to last year, when most group firms had made stellar gains in market capitalisation, this year, barring Adani Enterprises, Adani Power and Ambuja Cements, the rest of the companies have seen their valuations dip and as a result have seen their rankings slide in the BT500 list.

Why has there been a subdued growth in valuations, a conspicuous trend in this year's BT500 list? Market participants attribute it to a combination of factors including a spike in crude prices and geopolitical concerns, among other fears. "There have been concerns about crude oil levels, and while they are back at \$80 (Brent), they had been till recently above \$85, and those levels begin worrying markets, as India is a major crude importer," says R. Venkataraman, Chairman of IIFL Securities. He explains that the crude oil prices had spiked because of the worsening geopolitical situation, with the Russia-Ukraine war continuing and the Israel-Hamas conflict flaring up. "Further, the US Fed had initially sent the markets tumbling with another higher-for-

TOP 10 COMPANIES IN TERMS OF AVERAGE M-CAP

There has been no change in the Top 3 positions, with RIL, TCS and HDFC Bank retaining their ranks from last year

Rank 2023/2022	Company	Average m-cap
1/1	Reliance Industries	16,74,550 (-1.55%)
2/2	Tata Consultancy Services	12,13,956 (-5.25%)
3/3	HDFC Bank	9,68,605 (19.42%)
4/6	ICICI Bank	6,39,027 (19.85%)
5/5	Hindustan Unilever	6,04,858 (9.10%)
6/4	Infosys	5,99,162 (-13.48%)
7/8	State Bank of India	5,11,869 (15.48%)
8/13	ITC	4,93,804 (54.29%)
9/10	Bharti Airtel	4,89,925 (17.07%)
10/11	Bajaj Finance	4,07,997 (-1.94%)

AVERAGE MARKET CAP (M-CAP) IS FROM OCTOBER 2022 TO SEPTEMBER 2023; FIGURES ARE IN ₹ CRORE; FIGURES IN BRACKETS INDICATE YoY CHANGE **SOURCE** ACE EQUITY